

Make half of your grains whole grains

There's a myth that whole grains are only for sick people. The truth is that whole grains should be encouraged for everyone!

Intake of whole grains and wholegrain foods is extremely low. Most Malaysians, including children and adolescents, do not meet the recommended intake.

Why whole grains intake is so important?

The Malaysian Dietary Guidelines recommend that at least half of the grain products you eat everyday should be whole grains, because these may help to:



Meet your recommended daily intake of fibre



Stabilise your blood sugar level



Make you feel full longer



Reduce blood cholesterol and blood pressure levels



Promote a healthy balance of good gut bacteria



Improve digestion

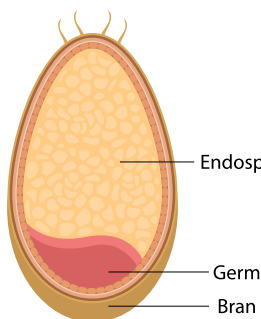


Improve your overall health

What is whole grain & refined grain

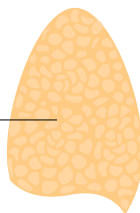
Whole grain

- Made up of all parts (bran, germ, endosperm)
- Bran and germ contain high amounts of important nutrients, namely vitamins, minerals, fibre & phytonutrients
- Also contains carbohydrates and some protein



Refined grain

- Made up of endosperm only (bran & germ removed)
- Contains mainly carbohydrates and some protein
- Contains only small amounts of vitamins, minerals & phytonutrients



Examples of whole grains



Brown rice



Oat



Corn



Whole wheat



Millet



Quinoa

Examples of wholegrain products



Wholegrain bread



Wholegrain cereals



Wholewheat flour



Wholemeal rice, noodle and pasta

Ideas to increase whole grain intake

Here are some suggestions to gradually incorporate whole grains into your diet:

- Mix white rice with whole grains such as brown rice, hulled barley, oat and corn
- Choose whole grain types of noodles and pasta, bread, breakfast cereals, biscuits and other cereal-based products
- Add whole grains such as corn to soups
- Check the label and choose products with higher percentages of whole grains



Examples of breakfast, lunch, dinner & snack with whole grains

Breakfast



Wholegrain oat cereal with fruits

Lunch



Brown rice with fish and vegetables

Dinner



Wholewheat seafood pasta with tomato sauce

Snack



Wholegrain bread with jam